

Speaker 1: Okay. And just for the sake of the video, um, is it alright if I start recording?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 1: And again, I apologize if the voice thing, um, kind of like... What, goes out. Just let me know to repeat the questions. Um, Yeah. So thank you for participating in this interview. As mentioned over email, uh, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. So first, I'm going to ask you a couple of demographic questions and then the rest would just be about your views on relationships.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: All right. So, how old are you?

Speaker 2: I am [20-25].

Speaker 1: [20-25], and how long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2: Uh... For [1-5] years.

Speaker 1: And do you have children?

Speaker 2: Uh, no.

Speaker 1: And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2: Uh, my [1-5] siblings, my two parents, and my grandma.

Speaker 1: And what is your main source of income or your current job?

Speaker 2: Uh, I don't have a job.

Speaker 1: Okay, and how would you like me to address your partner? Um, Girlfriend? Partner? Lover? By their name?

Speaker 2: Um, girlfriend is fine.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 1: Alright. So from here on now, um, just asking general questions and then, um, kind of like your love stories and such, and I'll just be taking notes on the side while you kind of explain to me, um, more about the questions.

Speaker 1: So, yeah. So first off, tell me about your love story.

Speaker 2: My love story?

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: Oh, well, it's kind of, like, complicated I guess. Um, I confessed to my girlfriend, uh, probably my freshman year. But, she sadly rejected me.

Speaker 2: And so then I went on and just had my own, like, relationship with someone else. I think it was my freshman year. No, it was my sophomore year, sorry, of high school— Um, and, well, that relationship didn't last long and after I broke up with my partner then, uh, my girlfriend right now confessed to me. And so then I also confessed again, and we decided to give it like [<1 year]. We said it was like a [<1 year] trial and then we began dating and we've been together since then. For quite—

Speaker 1: Well that's— Hmm.

Speaker 2: Yeah. We met in middle school, so we were, like, best friends before.

Speaker 1: Hmm.

Speaker 2: Yeah, that's it.

Speaker 1: Okay. So, um. Yeah. So you said the [<1 year] trial. So you guys unofficially dated? I'm guessing... or were—

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: And then... Um, and then out of, like, curiosity, why? Because you said that you confessed to her. But then she rejected you.

Speaker 2: Yeah

Speaker 1: And I'm guessing you guys were still friends during that time?

Speaker 2: Yes, we were.

Speaker 1: And then you went out with someone else, and then that ended.

Speaker 2: Mm hmm.

Speaker 1: After she confessed to you or...

Speaker 2: Oh. Before she confessed to me.

Speaker 1: Okay. And what made, what do you think made, uh, your girlfriend confess to you or what made her realize her emotions or her, um, feelings for you?

Speaker 2: Well, the reason she rejected me was because she was still figuring out her sexuality.

Speaker 2: And she had like a small crush on someone during that time, which was a girl.

Speaker 2: But that ended. And so then she began questioning herself more. And as we hung out more as friends, she realized that we were starting to feel like “die around me” or like really comfortable with me.

Speaker 2: And I think she just came. She just realized, I guess.

Speaker 1: Hmm... Okay. That's so cute. All right. So, um, comparing the, your relationship, your current relationship with that of your friends' relationships, how would you compare the quality of it?

Speaker 2: The quality? What do you mean by the quality? Sorry.

Speaker 1: So yeah, the quality as in, um, how the relationship, the relationship is navigated or, um, I guess feelings within the relationship. Like, for example, um, I have certain friends who have more of a lower quality since they're always complaining about arguing with their partner. They're saying “Oh my God, he hates me”, or, um, you know, “They don't get me” and “I'm always having to ask for things, things like that”, or even I have other friends that are like “I don't have time for anything. They just do whatever they want and I'm really happy in a way”. You know, that's pretty much what quality is.

Speaker 2: Oh, okay. So, then my relationship, my current relationship, I guess we have, like, some disagreements and some fights.

Speaker 2: Then there are, like, happy moments.

Speaker 2: Like we fulfill each other's needs. And we have, yeah. Like, I don't know. I guess we're, like, in between like having, like, a low quality and a high quality.

Speaker 2: I guess that's like leaning more towards, I don't know, it's hard.

Speaker 1: No. That's not...

Speaker 2: We're like, in the middle, I guess.

Speaker 1: Yeah, That's fair.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: How about your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: My friends' relationships, for them, I guess, more on like the lower quality just because there are, they're mostly in like situationships rather than like relationships.

Speaker 2: So yeah.

Speaker 2: They'd always like ends up at or yeah. So I'd say like low quality.

Speaker 1: Okay. Alright. And could I ask, um, how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2: The past... About... well, four.

Speaker 1: Okay. And comparing the quality of your current relationship to that of your previous relationships, um, how do you compare it?

Speaker 2: Um, my current relationships? Well, my current relationships are more like the high quality stuff. Stuff like communication and growth.

Speaker 2: And like. I said, fulfilling each other's needs, understanding each other. And like my past relationships lack all of that. And most of them were just like dumb relationships in middle school. And so, yeah. I think my current relationship is more like the high quality compared to past ones.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: Okay. So, overall, what makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2: What makes a relationship high quality for me is communication and understanding because lack of communication creates, like, big problems and lots of arguments.

Speaker 2: And you won't really understand each other because you lack communication skills.

Speaker 2: Or even if you have communication skills, your partner might not have, like, best skills. So it creates an unbalance between, like, both people, I guess.

Speaker 2: And also like giving equal effort and equally meeting each other's needs and not setting, like, high expectations for your partner.

Speaker 2: Spending quality time together as well.

Speaker 2: Yeah, I think those are, like, the main things.

Speaker 1: And you said not setting high expectations. So. You know, expectations are, I guess, different for different people. But what would you say are high expectations?

Speaker 2: High expectations, I guess. Um... Hmm... Again. It's like meeting every need your partner has, like them expecting you to meet every single thing. Or for example, your partner communicates with you that you do something wrong or they don't like what you do.

Speaker 2: Because it's been going on for like a while so then they, like, expect you to change within a day or a week when in reality like changes take time and a lot of energy and effort.

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: Yeah. What else? Hmm... I can't think of something else... Um...

Speaker 1: All right. That's fine.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Sorry.

Speaker 1: And... and what about you touched upon this a bit, but what about low quality? What makes their relationship low quality?

Speaker 2: Low quality. Um.

Speaker 2: I guess constant fights, insecurities. Um... insecurities... lack of effort.

Speaker 2: Um, not understanding your partner's needs and emotions.

Speaker 2: Um... I guess, like, jealousy. But on the, on the, like, extreme level.

Speaker 2: Control over your partner. Hm... Selfishness.

Speaker 2: And, like, I keep saying, like, lack of communication.

Speaker 2: I think those are like. The ones I could think of right now.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm.

Speaker 1: And. For you, what are the most important things in our relationship?

Speaker 2: Hmm... Important things in a relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:13:30] Hmm... Like expressing your... your love in small ways, small gestures, uh, quality time. Um...

Speaker 2: I keep saying communication, but communication. Um...

Speaker 1: Yeah, definitely.

Speaker 2: Yeah. And. Um... I mean like goals and... Um...What's the word for it... And supporting your partner to reach their own goals, setting like a future together. Like realistic futures together.

Speaker 2: You know, like, just planning ahead and getting ready for the future or, yeah.

Speaker 1: Yeah. And why do you think these are the most important in a relationship?

Speaker 2: I think these are, like, literally the most important things because it creates, like, strong connections and better bonding with your partner. I guess it creates, like, a healthier relationship. Like there might be, like, sides, disagreements. But both, like, sides are, like, being there.

Speaker 2: Like one partner. Like... Sorry. Like one of them won't feel, like, down. I don't know. I don't know how to explain it. I guess it just creates a better relationship or it just leads towards better. Better, um... You know, I just keep forgetting my words, sorry.

Speaker 1: It's okay. Take your time.

Speaker 2: I guess it leads towards a healthier relationship if you... Um... Try to improve those things.

Speaker 2: Um... Yeah. I think it just creates a healthier relationship.

Speaker 1: And more on the conceptual side of love, what is love?

Speaker 2: Love? Oh, that's hard. Um... Sorry, like none of the things I'm saying, like, make sense.

Speaker 1: No, they do. Yeah, they do.

Speaker 2: Okay. Well, love... Hmm... Love... I guess, love to me means you're willing to commit and you feel, um, like, attached to your partner.

Speaker 2: In a healthy way. Not in an unhealthy way. Um... You see your future with them. Um, you wanna, like, give in your all for your partner. You wanna, like, be happy with them.

Speaker 2: Um...

Speaker 2: What else? Hmm... You're willing to, like, make sacrifices for your partner or for your relationship. I think it's, like, it's commitment. Really. Like a hundred percent commitment.

Speaker 2: Yeah I think that's. Yeah, I think that's it.

Speaker 1: Right. And for you, how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2: I think it's very important. Like in a relationship, there is no love then I guess it's not a relationship. So I think it's very important.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. And how do you know your girlfriend loves you?

Speaker 2: I know my girlfriend loves me because she always expresses her love and, like, her own love language and she is willing to fix any, like, argument or problem we have instead of, like, the solution being, "Oh, let's break up". Since it is common, like, for, like, many other relationships, to just, like, break up.

Speaker 1: Yeah, definitely.

Speaker 2: Yeah. And she... she really listens to me and meets my needs or tries to meet my needs. And, um, she's patient with me as well. And she reassures me all the time. And, you know, she doesn't go a day without saying, "I love you", and... She also, like, goes out of her way to spend time with me, or when she does have the free time, she... she spends time with me at least like a couple hours or we plan like this one day. And—

Speaker 1: Mm hmm.

Speaker 2: Yeah, she.. she expresses that she's, like, she feels at home with me. So. And then she sees, like, a future with me and then she... she really wants to get married and start a family.

Speaker 1: Oh.

Speaker 2: She expresses it, like, in a lot of ways. I can make a whole list. But yeah.

Speaker 2: That's how I know. That's how I know she loves me.

Speaker 1: That's good.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: And what would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Some challenges, I guess, would be our, like, mental health or sometimes our mental... Like, we start feeling, like, some sort of way? Like, I don't know, like... I, like, suffer from, like... Well, not suffer. But, like, I have anxiety and she's, she has, like, depression. So sometimes we have, like, those episodes and becomes challenging because sometimes it's hard to communicate when we have our, like, small episodes.

Speaker 2: And, so then they, like, sometimes, either one of us just feels like we're not cared about. Or like I don't care about her or she doesn't care about me. So, like, that's like the main thing... And jealousy, too. Sometimes it could get in the way of creating friendships or bonding with other people because jealousy, jealousy gets in the way of it.

Speaker 2: Hmm... What else? That's it. Those are the two main things.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. All right. And tell me more about the jealousy part. You said it gets in the way of creating friendships.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: In what ways?

Speaker 2: Oh, well, like, for example, I'll start, like, making a new friend, and my girlfriend will, like, start overthinking and get jealous, which then, like, makes me feel like I can break the friendship I want because I don't want my partner to like overthinking and cause like she'll start thinking "Oh, they're going to start liking her" or like, people she's going to like leave me for them.

Speaker 2: Yeah. At least those kinds of things.

Speaker 1: Okay

Speaker 2: Or like for example, when she's, like, hanging out with her friends, I, like, feel jealous that she's not with me. And so then I, like, I guess, bother her while she's hanging out with her old friends just because I feel, like, jealous.

Speaker 1: All right. So you mentioned it. In, um, in the past, but do you and your girlfriend fight?

Speaker 2: Hmm... Yeah, we have fights. Not, like, physically. Like—

Speaker 1: Yeah, yeah, yeah

Speaker 2: Yeah. We do.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. And how often would you say these fights are?

Speaker 2: Oh. Well... Um... I think it's like at least three big fights a month.

Speaker 1: And what are these fights usually about?

Speaker 2: They're mainly like, over dumb, like, things.

Speaker 2: Like, literally, they'll be over, like me being so dramatic about something. I think the press one was, like, for losing a promise ring. I overreacted and it created a big fight. And so it'll be over like the dumbest reasons.

Speaker 1: All right. Um... And how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker 2: We give each other time to think about it. We give each other space to really think about it. And if we're not tired or we feel ready to talk after a while, then we'll talk about it. And um, because like in the moment when we're fighting, we're like, not thinking right. We're not thinking straight. And so we'll just, like, say dumb stuff. And like, once we give each other, like, space, we calm down and really think through our words and we talk about it or like, tell each other what we meant or what we didn't mean. And so then, like, it resolves.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: All right. And what are some other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2: Our ways that we maintain. Hm... Can I have, like, an example. Sorry.

Speaker 1: No, yeah. Um... Let's see. I mean you know, you mentioned, like, communication, um, giving time and space. I guess you can think of an issue and how you were able to resolve it in a different way. It could also, you could talk more in depth with, um, your love languages, too.

Speaker 2: Well. Um... The ways we maintain. What we maintain.

Speaker 2 : I guess, like, what you said, like, love languages. Her love language is like affirmations and, like, physical touch.

Speaker 2: I guess she, like, hugs me and reassures me, like I said earlier. Um, and I, my love language is like giving gifts. I love giving gifts. So then I get her like small little stuff that I think she'll like.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm.

Speaker 2: Or like, she collects notebooks. She loves notebooks. So when I see, like, a cute notebook, I'll get it for her.

Speaker 2: Even though I know she probably won't use them. Or like, small little, like, things. Like small little cute action figures or small things, or pens, just stuff that you, like, fix-fixates. I don't know how to say the word.

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: So I guess that. That's how we also maintain our relationship.

Speaker 1: Yeah, that's really sweet. And I guess, um, kind of like putting in my own example from my past relationships. Um... How do you coordinate your love languages? Um... Because you said your girlfriend's love languages are affirmations and physical touch and yours is like gift giving. Because, I do. Even like with my friendships, I come across, um, situations where... Because, for example, my roommate's love language is gift giving, and she tends to give me things and I have communicated that I don't really like gifts.

Speaker 2: Oh.

Speaker 1: How do you, like, coordinate in that way?

Speaker 2: I mean—

Speaker 1: Since you guys have different love languages.

Speaker 2: I think it's just, it just happens, like, spontaneously. Like, we don't really, like. I don't know. Like, I'll just give her, like, small things randomly...

Speaker 1: [Redacted].

Speaker 2: But, I guess, like, I set boundaries there.

Speaker 1: Mhm.

Speaker 2: And for the affirmations, I just, like. She'll just do it randomly, like through text then in person.

Speaker 1: Mhm.

Speaker 2: But like—

Speaker 1: Cool! And overall, would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2: I think, um, My relationship is good for me because, um, like before, like getting into this relationship, I was like, learning. Like. I wasn't like, mentally okay. Like, I was like, very like at my lowest.

Speaker 1: Like family stuff. And once I got into, like, my current relationship, I learned a lot of things from her. Like how to, like, keep myself calm, and she has supported me a lot and has been here for me a lot as my girlfriend and as my best friend. And I've been able to really keep myself, like, I guess, stable.

Speaker 2: But I'm still, like. Sometimes I will just, not go crazy. But you know, have my moments.

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: She reassures me that I'll be okay.

Speaker 2: Like right now, for example, I feel like I'm gonna fail all of my classes. She reassures me that I'll be fine and that I'm doing my best and I'll be okay.

Speaker 2: But I guess like—

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 2: Yeah. And I, like, changed, also, like, for the better since I've been in this relationship. So I think it's... It's been very good for me emotionally and mentally.

Speaker 1: And. Yeah. So tell me more about how the relationship changed you.

Speaker 2: Um. Well, I used to. Well, because I grew up in, like, the. Well. Yeah. I grew up in a household where, like, affection and love wasn't really expressed and still isn't expressed. It's very awkward when I get a hug from my dad.

Speaker 2: So, because I grew up in a household like that, I didn't really like affection. Like I found it cringe, like, it's so uncomfortable. Like getting hugs or, I don't know. It was weird to me, but once I got into, like, once I started dating my girlfriend, I, like, got really used to needing love and being shown love. And so then I think that made me more of a positive person.

Speaker 2: And also I've been able to like. Find my own personality and feel like myself around my girlfriend. And because of that I've been able to really put myself out there, I guess, like not being afraid of being myself with others.

Speaker 2: Um... What else? And I've been more of, like, a hopeful person. Because usually I'd be like, no, like, I guess think on more, more on like the realistic side.

Speaker 2: Instead of like, reading, like false hope.

Speaker 2: Even though I'm still, like, on the realistic side, I still keep hope. Like I've been a hopeful person. And yeah, I think those are, like, the major stu- things.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. Yeah.

Speaker 1: And. Yeah. When you said find your own personality, what did you mean by that?

Speaker 2: Well, because I grew up without having much friends. I jumped from, like, friend group to friend group. So I just, like, picked up on each person's personality just to fit in. And but, once I, like, became best friends and so dating my... my girlfriend, I. I guess I, like, was able to find my own personality where I feel comfortable with myself. I feel like it's natural, I guess, rather than picking up on anyone's personality.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: Oh, okay. And what about your girlfriend? Do you think she changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2: Yeah. I think she has changed a lot.

Speaker 1: And, uh, this is kind of similar, but is the person you were before the relationship the same as the person you are now?

Speaker 2: No

Speaker 1: And is your partner the same before the relationship as they are now?

Speaker 2: No

Speaker 1: You said "no"?

Speaker 1: All right. And in general, do you feel safe in the relationship and what do you say so?

Speaker 2: Yes, I do feel safe, uh, because I can be myself around her without being judged or being told things. And I... she does a lot for me so I can feel comfortable with her by my side.

Speaker 2: And, uh, yeah. I don't feel, like, threatened or anything by her. Yeah.

Speaker 1: Cool! And for this one, I'm going to, um, show my screen.

Speaker 1: Okay... Alright. Uh, can you see my screen?

Speaker 2: Uh, no.

Speaker 1: Wait, give me one sec. This one?

Speaker 2: Yeah, I can see now.

Speaker 1: Okay, So this is, um, pretty much a Likert scale and I will just be reading you the statements and you kind of rate it from 1 to 9, I believe it's like three of them. Um, so the very first one, my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker 2: Hmm... Probably a seven.

Speaker 1: Seven? and I'm taking the other side... And why do you say so? Or in other words, why not an eight? Or why not a six?

Speaker 2: Um, because there are some stuff that she like, I guess. Does it acknowledge as much and or she just doesn't understand some stuff. So, it's like. Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. And.. why not... Why not a six?

Speaker 2: Um, because, like, even though she doesn't understand or doesn't acknowledge it, she will take the time to listen to me, I guess.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. Okay, cool. And next one.

Speaker 2: Whoops.

Speaker 1: Yeah.

Speaker 1: My partner usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2: Well... Hmm... Probably an eight.

Speaker 1: Alright, eight. And why not a seven?

Speaker 2: Um, because she tries her best to respond to my needs. This might sound like being able. Well, sorry. Despite her feeling, like, Sometimes you can't meet them or respond to them.

Speaker 1: Mm hmm. And why not a nine?

Speaker 2: Because like I said, there's just some stuff that she can't really, like, do for me or, like, do... The... meet my needs.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: All right. And this one. How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2: Um... Very satisfied.

Speaker 1: Alright. And why do you say so?

Speaker 2: Because there are still some, like, stuff that we need to work on individually and together to really like... I guess not necessarily, but be like the perfect couple, I guess.

Speaker 2: Um... And we still have like... Like... Yeah. That's basically improvable.

Speaker 1: Alright.

Speaker 1: Yeah, that's pretty much it. But I'll just ask, like, some additional questions for "My partner usually really listens to me.", you said that some stuff... There's some stuff that she doesn't acknowledge or understand. Like, could you give me some examples?

Speaker 2: And I guess when for example, I'm having a breakdown, like, you know, express what I'm feeling.

Speaker 2: And like, what? Yeah, I'll express what I'm feeling. Then she'll, like, say the wrong stuff just because she isn't understanding what I'm going through.

Speaker 2: That'll make. And what she says, like, makes me feel even, like, worse. So I guess that's an example.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: Okay. And... um... would you say that the example would kind of, like, explain also why she isn't completely, uh, responsive to your needs.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Okay. All right. Yeah, that's... That's it. I'm going to stop sharing my screen and just finish the last couple of questions.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: All right, so. Yeah. So. I hope you don't mind if I ask both. Feel free to say if it's too sensitive for you to share. Um... But I wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Would you like to continue? These are only two questions.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 1: All right. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2: Probably, like... Zero.

Speaker 1: Zero?

Speaker 2: Zero times. Yeah. Because we never have privacy.

Speaker 1: Completely understandable.

Speaker 1: And yes, I'm moving forward and I don't know if I asked his question already. Okay. So did the relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 2: I think so.

Speaker 1: And why do you think so?

Speaker 2: Hmm... because she'd like this so much. You know, I don't really have, like, any more expectations or I just feel like I can't make any expectations just because she, like... Like I said, there's so much for me and for our relationship.

Speaker 1: Mhm. Great. All right. So we're close to wrapping up. And I just want to summarize what we've talked about in the past hour. Um, so I'll just give a brief summary for each. Keep in mind that I do have the details in here. So in terms of your love story, you confessed to her sophomore year of high school. Uh, you got rejected. Then you got into a relationship and broke up with them. And then your current girlfriend confessed to you. Uh, you had like a [<1 year] trial, unofficial dating, and then you started dating after that.

Speaker 1: And the... When comparing the quality of your relationship with that of your friends' relationship, you said that your friends have more of a lower quality because they're more in situationships. You've had [1-5] romantic partners in the past, but your current relationship is more of a higher quality than that because, um, as you said, the past relationships were mostly in middle school.

Speaker 1: What makes the relationship high quality? You said communication, understanding, not having high expectations. For quality time with each other and low quality would be constant fights, insecurities, lack of effort, not understanding, um, each other's needs and emotions like, um, making control over the other person. Have... being selfish and lack of communication. And the most important things in a relationship are expressing love through small gestures, quality time, communication, sharing goals, supporting each other, either in your own individual goals or with the, um, relationship, and then making a realistic future with each other. For you love is when you're willing to commit and feel attached to your partner in a healthy way and see a future with them and give them your all, and you're happy with them, and you make sacrifices for each other. And you said, love is very important in our relationship. And you said that you know, your partner loves you because she expresses her love in her own languages and also in your love language. You said that some challenges that you have. Is the mental health aspect as well as jealousy. You said you and your partner fight around like three big fights a month about all stuff. And some... But then you give each other space to think about it... And, um... Some time to think about it. And then you talk about the issue. Some other ways that you maintain it are love languages and setting boundaries and doing, like, small things for each other. You said that the relationship is good for you and that the relationship did change you and your partner and you feel definitely safe with them. In terms of the Likert scale, you said that.... From... For "My partner usually really listens to me" you rated it a seven. For "My partner is usually responsive to my needs" you rated it an eight, if you feel, um, satisfied in your relationship, you said you feel very satisfied.

Speaker 1: Yeah

Speaker 1: And you said that battle your patience. And yeah, though. And yeah, that's pretty much a summary. Is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2: Well, actually, I would like to, like, change the very, very first one. I mix it up a lot. But, I actually—

Speaker 1: The Likert Scale?

Speaker 2: Sorry, what?

Speaker 1: Of the Likert scale or the very first question?

Speaker 2: The very first question on the love story.

Speaker 1: Okay. Okay. Yeah. Go ahead.

Speaker 2: I actually confessed my freshman year.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: And I dated someone on my freshman year, but then, you know, I broke up with them, and I started dating my current girlfriend my sophomore year.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Yeah. Sorry. I got it. I got it mixed up.

Speaker 1: Yeah. That's totally fine... Sorry. Do you hear me?

Speaker 2: Uh, no.

Speaker 1: Okay. Hold on. Let me, uh, text, because my wifi is sucking right now.

Speaker 2: That is correct.

Speaker 1: Okay. Okay. Got it. Okay.

Speaker 1: And your current girlfriend confessed. You... You started going out with your current girlfriend because they confessed to you?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: And because I confessed too. Well, she confessed first.

Speaker 1: Okay. Yeah.

Speaker 1: Okay. All right. Anything else you like to add?

Speaker 2: No, that was it.

Speaker 1: All right, so. Um, yeah. So thank you so much. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we handle the data. So as a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible.

Speaker 2: I don't know you're speaking. I can't hear you.

Speaker 2: Hello?

Speaker 1: Hello? Oh, my God. I'm so sorry.

Speaker 2: No, it's okay.

Speaker 1: Hear me?

Speaker 2: Yes, I can.

Speaker 1: Okay. Yeah. Because I'm using my phone data, so.

Speaker 2: Oh, okay. No. Yeah, I am, too. I'm in the parking garage, so I don't know if it's my wifi or your wifi.

Speaker 1: Most likely mine. But, okay. Let's see. Yeah. So did you hear the first? I'll read the first option again. So in the first option, the transcript portions. So some portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the transcript can also be read by other researchers. Or if you were bolder, um, the whole transcript can be shared. But sensitive information will be removed and overly identifying details. So it will be anonymized. However, in this option, there is a very, very minimal chance that someone

who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is, although again, sensitive information will be shared. So of the two options, which are you most comfortable with?

Speaker 2: Both would be anonymous, right?

Speaker 1: Yes.

Speaker 2: Um... I think the second one.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: All right. Um, so, yeah. So thank you so much again for participating in this study. I would like to let you know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and all over the US. And for this study to be successful, there is also one more thing, um, I will ask of you if that's okay for you.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: Could you recommend to close people in your life as a nominator? We would ask them for an additional couple that might be interested in the study, but will be asking them for a couple that you don't know or interact with. In this way, we could get as diverse of a network we can get. Is that okay with you?

Speaker 2: Um, yeah.

Speaker 1: So do you have anyone in mind in terms of like the categories I sent?

Speaker 1: Um, do... I can read them all for you if you want.

Speaker 2: Oh, yes please.

Speaker 1: Okay. So. Um... So that one was fulfilled already. But a heterosexual couple who have been together 5 to 10 years. Or a heterosexual couple who have been together 10 to 20 years with high satisfaction. Or a heterosexual couple who have been together 20 plus years with low satisfaction. Um, yeah.

Speaker 1: Does any of them ring a bell?

Speaker 2: Oh, probably not.

Speaker 1: Okay.

Speaker 2: Sorry.

Speaker 1 [00:57:10] All right. So that's pretty much it. And yeah, so thank you again. And yeah. Do you have any questions for me?

Speaker 2 [00:57:19] Um, nope.

Speaker 1 [00:57:20] All right. Sounds good. All right. And I will be reaching out to your girlfriend maybe tomorrow, most likely, because I have a lot of meetings today. But yeah, so thank you so much. And have a rest... Have a good rest of your day.

Speaker 2 [00:57:35] Okay. Thank you so much. Have a good day to.

Speaker 1 [00:57:38] Okay, bye!